



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

*alamarthena kāmēna sukṛtenāpi karmaṇā |
ebhyaḥ saṃsāra-kāntāre na viśrāntamabhūnmanaḥ || 10 | 7 | |
kṛtaṃ na kati janmāni kāyena manasā girā |
duḥkhamāyāsadaṃ karma tadadyāpyuparamyatām || 10 | 8 | |*

— Aṣṭāvakra-gītā, Prakaraṇa 10 (Chapter 10), Verses 7-8

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

Enough of chasing after wealth, desires, and even virtuous deeds! Ashtavakra is cutting through the illusions that keep you bound to the endless cycle of rebirth, the "saṃsāra-kāntāre," or the wilderness of worldly existence. Your mind, restless and yearning, has found no true rest in these pursuits. Think about it: how many times have you believed that *this* achievement, *this* possession, or *this* relationship would finally bring you lasting peace? Yet, here you are, still searching. This verse highlights the futility of seeking ultimate fulfillment in the external world. It's not that these things are inherently bad, but rather that they are impermanent and cannot provide the enduring contentment you crave.

The second verse amplifies this message with stark clarity. How many lifetimes have you spent toiling with your body, mind, and speech, engaging in actions that ultimately lead to suffering and exhaustion? "Duḥkhamāyāsadaṃ karma" – actions that yield only pain and toil. Consider all the energy you pour into striving, achieving, and maintaining, often driven by fear, insecurity, or the need for validation. Ashtavakra urges you to bring this cycle to an immediate halt: "tadadyāpyuparamyatām." Stop it now! This isn't a call for inaction, but rather a call for a radical shift in your motivation. Instead of acting from a place of lack and striving, begin to act from a place of inner fullness and awareness.

In modern life, this wisdom is profoundly relevant. We are constantly bombarded with messages that tell us we need more – more money, more success, more beauty, more experiences. But Ashtavakra reminds you that true happiness lies not in accumulating more, but in recognizing the inherent completeness within yourself. It is about disentangling yourself from the relentless pursuit of external validation and turning inward to discover the boundless peace that already exists within your own being. It is about recognizing the truth of who you are, beyond the limitations of your body, mind, and ego.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

What habitual action, driven by a desire for external validation, can you consciously release today to create space for inner peace?